Social Security Administration (SSA) Joint Processing of CalFresh Application	**Number**	**Page**
	63-333	**1 of 3**

Revision Date:
2/1/2025

Background:
As of June 1, 2019, CalFresh program eligibility expanded to include households (HHs) that consist solely of Supplemental Security Income (SSI)/State Supplementary Payment (SSP) recipients. To support this change, a national Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) has been established outlining CalFresh related services that the SSA will provide, including the SSA operations for taking applications.

Purpose:
This section outlines the SSA joint application process and the transition from the GetCalFresh application assistance tool to the BenefitsCal online portal for the submission of CalFresh applications by the SSA.

Policy:
Under federal regulations, HHs including only SSI/SSP applicants or recipients may apply and be certified for CalFresh under SSA joint processing procedures, if all eligibility criteria are met. HHs that include both SSI/SSP applicants or recipients and non-SSI applicant or recipient members must be referred by the SSA to the BenefitsCal online application or their nearest Family Resource Center (FRC) to apply for CalFresh benefits.

1. HHs Eligible for Joint Processing

To be eligible under joint processing procedures, all HH members must be SSI/SSP applicants or recipients and must:

- Not currently receive CalFresh benefits; or
- Be receiving CalFresh and have received a recertification notice in the last 30 days; or
- Have applied for CalFresh in the last 60 days but were denied; and
- Have agreed to apply through the SSA.

2. Application Submission from SSA

When the SSA determines the SSI/SSP HH is eligible under joint processing and the HH agrees to the SSA application assistance, the SSA must assist the HH in completing and submitting a CalFresh initial application or application for recertification. The SSA must submit the application electronically through BenefitsCal. When an application is received from the SSA through BenefitsCal, do not request an additional signature from the HH, the signature of the SSA technician assisting the HH is sufficient.

The default method for the SSA to assist HHs with submitting a CalFresh initial application or application for recertification is BenefitsCal; however, the HH may request to submit a paper application. The SSA must assist the HH in completing and submitting a paper application to the county's Document Processing Center (DPC) within one business day of receipt of the signed application along with the SSA Transmittal for Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program Applications (SSA 4233) cover sheet.

3. Date of Application

For applications received electronically, the application file date will be the date it is received via the interface at the DPC.

For applications submitted on paper at the SSA office, the application file date will be the date the office receives the signed paper application. SSA will indicate the date of receipt on the application.

4. Expedited Services (ES)

The ES processing time standard will begin on the date the signed application is received by the county. The SSA technician will screen the application for ES eligibility on the day the signed application is received by SSA. For paper applications, if the customer appears potentially eligible to ES, the SSA technician will note "Expedited Processing" on the first page of the application. The county will screen all applications for ES, whether or not the SSA technician has identified the application as potentially eligible to ES.

5. No Interview Requirement

Applications processed under SSA joint processing procedures do not require an interview. The county may only contact the HH to obtain information on incurred expenses for allowable deductions or to complete the eligibility determination if:

- The application is incomplete;
- Mandatory verification is missing; or
- The county determined the information on the application is questionable.

When reviewing the application for eligibility determination, ensure that all HH members are applicants or recipients of SSI/SSP. If a HH member's SSI/SSP status is terminated or denied during the eligibility determination period, an interview must be completed.

6. Verification

Mandatory information must be verified to determine eligibility. Prior to requesting verification from the HH, verify SSI/SSP recipient income, payment status, and all other applicable information using existing data matches and databases such as:

- Payment Verification System (PVS).
- Income and Eligibility Verification System (IEVS).
- Medi-Cal Eligibility Data System (MEDS).

7. Certification Periods

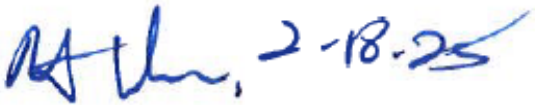
HHs processed under SSA joint processing procedures must be certified for 24 or 36-month certification period depending on the HH type. Refer to table below to determine certification period.

HHs in which all members are Elderly and/or Disabled (E/D) and have…	will be assigned a…
earned income,	24-month certification period.
no earned income,	36-month certification period.

References:
All County Letters (ACL) 18-90, 18-90E and 19-44.
Manual of Policy and Procedures (MPP) 63-402.226.
Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) 273.1(b)(7)(ii) and 273.2(k)(1)(i)(A).
Assembly Bill (AB) 1811.

Sunset Date:
This policy will be reviewed for continuance on or by 02/29/2028.

Approval for Release:



Rick Wanne, Director
Self-Sufficiency Services